CALIFORNIA DIRECT IMPORTING COMPANY

CDIC

Honoring the Past. *Building the Future.*

A research briefing on CDIC's heritage, its market, and the opportunities to strengthen, modernize and grow the business.



View up Powell Street from the Fairmont, c. 1920. Library of Congress, LCCN 96514400 (public domain). San Francisco context only. Not CDIC premises.

PREPARED FOR
CDIC OWNERSHIP

PREPARED BY
LO · DAILY GRIND MEDIA

RESEARCH
NOVEMBER 2026

ABOUT THIS BRIEFING

“A business with a remarkable history, an established presence in a valuable market, and meaningful opportunities to strengthen how we present ourselves, serve customers and pursue growth.”

This briefing brings together research across five areas: CDIC's historical records, the Bay Area corporate coffee market, the competitive landscape, Franke A1000 service standards, and modern brand and business systems.

It's a starting point for a conversation. The findings are drawn from public records and published sources, and the ideas are offered for discussion.

— Lo, Daily Grind Media

HOW TO READ THIS BRIEFING

OWNER-REPORTED	Details shared by CDIC ownership, accepted as context.
RESEARCH	Found in outside sources: directories, filings, market reports. Traceable and cited.
RECOMMENDATION	A suggestion for discussion. Nothing here is decided until ownership approves it.
TO VERIFY	Details to confirm together from company records or family memory.

Historical leads are presented as leads. Contemporary photographs are representative, and no image in this briefing is AI-generated.



01

A Legacy *Worth Preserving*

What the public record shows, and where more of the story is waiting.

Market Street, San Francisco, early 1900s. Detroit Photographic Co. postcard, NYPL Digital Collections (public domain). Context only. Not CDIC premises.

The record so far

A name that appears in San Francisco's records *across the century.*

Each entry is a documented lead. Connecting them into one continuous story is the next step, with family records.

1917

1031 Market St.

City directory listing for "California Direct Importing Co."

● RESEARCH LEAD

1920

2651 Mission St.

Directory listing at the Mission address.

● RESEARCH LEAD

1923

A newspaper ad

Vestkusten, Dec. 13, p. 7, indexed by name and address.

● RESEARCH LEAD

1954

2653 Mission St.

Polk directory transcription: groceries and meats.

● RESEARCH LEAD

1961–71

2651 Mission recurs

Repeated in city directories through the '60s.

● RESEARCH LEAD

1971

State filing

Earliest visible entry for corporation C0095574 ("Term Perpetual").

● RESEARCH LEAD

2013

The modern LLC

California Direct Importing Company, LLC registered.

● RESEARCH

Today

Premium corporate coffee

Franke A1000 installations and fresh-roasted coffee for Bay Area offices.

● OWNER-REPORTED

UNDATED FIND

A Digger Archives leaflet lists **"Oh's (California Direct Importing Co.), 2651 Mission at 23rd"**, selling flour in 100-lb sacks. "Oh's" may be a family or trading name, and the family's memory can tell us more.

Sources: SF directories (sfgenealogy.org, archive.org) · CDNC/UCR · OpenCorporates · diggers.org

Telling the story accurately

Heritage is worth more *when every word can be backed up.*

● WHAT'S DOCUMENTED

Real leads

Name and addresses in directories from **1917** onward

A **1923** newspaper advertisement

Historical corporation **C0095574** at 2651 Mission

● WORDING TO CONFIRM

Say it precisely

Founding date. Not yet established by records. An earlier "1921" reading has been withdrawn.

"Since 1917." Use once the company's continuous history is documented.

Early import records reflect history, not today's coffee business.

● WHERE TO LOOK NEXT

Untold story

Family photos, letterhead, invoices, signs

City assessor photos of **2651/2653 Mission** (SF Public Library)

The original 1923 ad and the state corporate file

No public archive has yet surfaced a photograph of a CDIC storefront, vehicle or installation, which makes the family's own collection the richest source for the story.

Directory and filing leads via SF Genealogy, archive.org, OpenCorporates



"Banking Center," San Francisco, c. 1920. Library of Congress, LCCN 2002711388 (public domain). Context only. Not CDIC premises.



02

The Corporate Coffee *Market Today*

Workplaces are investing in the on-site experience, and coffee is at the center of it.

Photo: Scott K / Unsplash. Representative imagery, not a CDIC installation.

Market signals

People are coming back to the office, *and they expect good coffee there.*

48%

of American adults drank specialty coffee in the past day, a new high. 47% had an espresso-based drink in the past week.

NCA National Coffee Data Trends, Fall 2026 · national, not Bay Area

12.1M sq ft

of San Francisco office space leased through Q3 2026, up from 8.1M in the same period of 2025. AI and tech firms are driving much of it.

Savills San Francisco Office Report, Q3 2026

80%

average *peak* office utilization in 2025, against 53% on an average day. Demand comes in waves.

CBRE global workplace research, 2026

• WHAT IT MEANS

New leases, expansions and renovations are the moments when companies choose a coffee partner. Hybrid schedules favor equipment sized for peak days and programs that flex on quieter ones. Coffee supports the workplace experience; it shouldn't be sold as a cure for return-to-office or retention.

Indicators only: none of these figures measures Bay Area office coffee spending

The Bay Area opportunity

The best-fit workplaces *value quality and reliability.*

Premium headquarters	Concentrated offices with roughly 100–300 regular on-site users. Peak queues may call for more than one station.
Law, finance & professional firms	Roughly 60–200 on site plus client visitors. Presentation matters as much as volume.
Multi-floor corporate & tech	200–600+ on site. Multi-station programs with consistent service across floors.
Property & flex amenities	Shared tenant lounges, sized to the actual space, with clear agreements on who pays and who has access.
Customer-owned equipment	Offices that already own commercial machines and need expert care and coffee supply.

MOMENTS WHEN COMPANIES CHOOSE

New offices and expansions · renovations · replacing an unreliable provider · client-facing upgrades

WHO'S INVOLVED IN THE DECISION

Workplace experience · facilities · office managers · procurement · finance · IT for connected equipment

A Franke A1000 is rated for up to 300 cups a day. Sizing is based on real daily drinks, peaks and layout, not headcount alone.

● RESEARCH Segment sizes are planning ranges, not manufacturer guarantees

03 · Competitive Landscape & Positioning

A crowded field, *with very different approaches.*

Canteen · First Choice	National-scale breadth: coffee, pantry, vending, micro-markets and large route networks.
Royal Cup	Roaster-distributor with SF service and heritage "since 1896." Heritage alone isn't unique in this market.
C&S · BayCo · Blaisdell's	Local refreshment providers, often placing basic brewers within supply contracts.
Reliant · Break Coffee	Managed automatic programs with advertised per-drink pricing, trials and response promises.
Equator · Red Bay	Bay Area specialty roasters. Possible competitors, or possible coffee partners.
Nood Coffee	Mobile espresso for events and launches. A hospitality benchmark, not a permanent program.



Photo: Kevin Butz / Unsplash. Representative.

THE PATTERN

Large providers compete on breadth. Roasters compete on coffee. Automated programs compete on convenience. Few combine all three with a premium installation and a personal relationship.

Provider claims are their own published marketing, not tested performance · Research, Nov 2026

Positioning

Premium corporate coffee experiences, *fully managed.*

A working positioning line for CDIC: a refined coffee bar experience inside the workplace, backed by accountable local service.

01
Family heritage
A San Francisco story few providers can tell.

02
Refined installations
Swiss Franke systems, thoughtfully designed into the space.

03
Fresh-roasted coffee
Quality the customer can taste in every cup.

04
Accountable service
Clear standards, documented care, prompt follow-through.

05
Personal relationships
A local partner who knows each account by name.

• THE ADVANTAGE

Each ingredient exists somewhere in the market. The combination, shown through real installations, documented service and permissioned references, is what competitors find hard to copy. Proof is the advantage, not the slogan.

Claims such as "authorized dealer" or "zero downtime" are used only with documentation



Photo: Anastasiia Chepinska / Unsplash

04 · The CDIC Opportunity

Already built on *what the premium market wants.*

OWNER-REPORTED

Premium Franke installations

The Franke A1000 at the core: programmable recipes, barista-quality drinks, rated for up to 300 cups a day.

OWNER-REPORTED

Fresh-roasted coffee

A coffee program built around freshness, the quality signal buyers notice first.

OWNER-REPORTED

Established relationships

A history of serving major corporate workplaces. With permission, these become CDIC's strongest proof.

RESEARCH

A deep San Francisco story

A name in the city's records for about a century, rare among workplace coffee providers.

OPPORTUNITY Present these strengths clearly, consistently and with proof, and they become a competitive edge.

Equipment capacity: Franke A1000 US specification sheet

Growth avenues

Five ways to grow, *in order of fit.*

1	Premium managed coffee	CDIC's core offer: installation, coffee and named account care, with customer-owned or CDIC-supplied equipment.
2	Equipment care + coffee	For offices that already own qualified commercial machines: assessment, preventive care and supply.
3	Design-integrated installs	New offices and renovations: coffee planned into the space with designers and architects.
4	Property & shared amenities	Programs for building lounges and flex spaces that serve many tenants at once.
5	Hospitality & events	Staffed coffee for meetings and launches, best piloted with a partner first.

WHERE NEW ACCOUNTS COME FROM

- **Reconnect** with past and existing relationships first
- **Referrals** from service partners, facilities and property managers
- **Designers & architects** planning new workplaces
- **A focused target list** built around moves, renovations and expansions

Tasting → demo → proposal → pilot where warranted → install → review & renew

● RECOMMENDATION Ranked by fit with CDIC's current offering · Research, Nov 2026

05 · Strengthening the Customer Experience

A consistent experience, *from the first tasting to every renewal.*



Photo: nameless 3791 / Unsplash. Representative.

i.

Every machine, on record

One register for each site and station: serial number, install date, warranty and full service history.

ii.

Preventive care, scheduled

The A1000 calls for at least daily cleaning and technician service every 6 months or 80,000 drinks, scheduled and recorded at every site.

iii.

Supplies always on hand

Coffee, milk and cups tracked per site and reordered against real usage.

iv.

One simple way to reach us

Customers request service through one channel, get a prompt acknowledgment, and see it resolved.

SITE SURVEY → INSTALL & COMMISSION → TRAIN SITE STAFF → RECURRING CARE → SERVICE UPDATES → REVIEW & RENEW

● GOAL Every site, machine and request is documented, so every customer gets the same standard of care.

Maintenance figures: Franke A1000 manual (2016 revision), to be confirmed against current unit manuals



Photo: Adlo Lens / Unsplash. Representative workplace.

06 · Modernizing the Brand & Business

Modern where it helps the customer. *Simple everywhere else.*

CUSTOMER-FACING

A clear website and inquiry path

Who CDIC is today, what it offers, where it serves, how to get in touch.

CRM and follow-up

Inquiries, proposals and renewals tracked in one place, using GoHighLevel, which DGM already runs.

Helpful automation

Inquiry acknowledgments, proposal reminders, service updates and renewal prompts.

BEHIND THE SCENES

Equipment and service history

Test GoHighLevel side by side with a field-service tool (Zoho FSM or Jobber) on one real account.

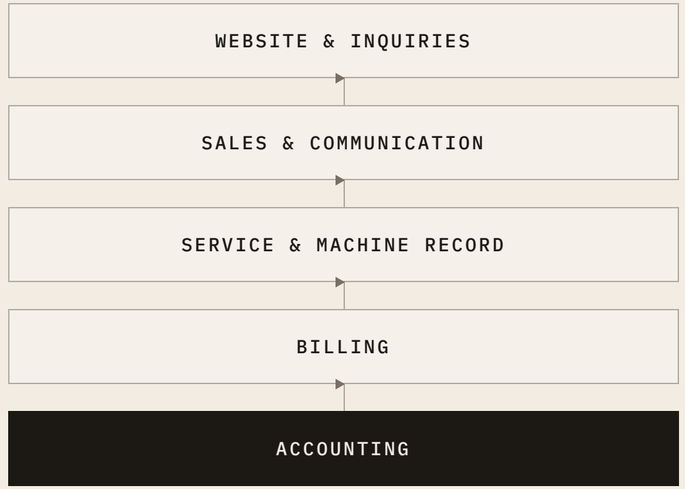
Keep the accounting that works

Existing accounting stays in place, with one source for invoices.

Build only what's needed

No custom apps or new subscriptions until a real need is proven.

HOW IT CONNECTS



● RECOMMENDATION Nothing is purchased or built without ownership approval

Bringing the brand to life

Let CDIC tell *its own story*.

Today, searches for the company mostly return third-party records and customs listings. A company-controlled presence puts CDIC's heritage, offer and service front and center.

PROPOSED WEBSITE

HOME | ABOUT & HERITAGE | SOLUTIONS | WORKPLACES WE SERVE | INSTALLATION & SUPPORT | RESOURCES | CONTACT & QUOTE

Real photography

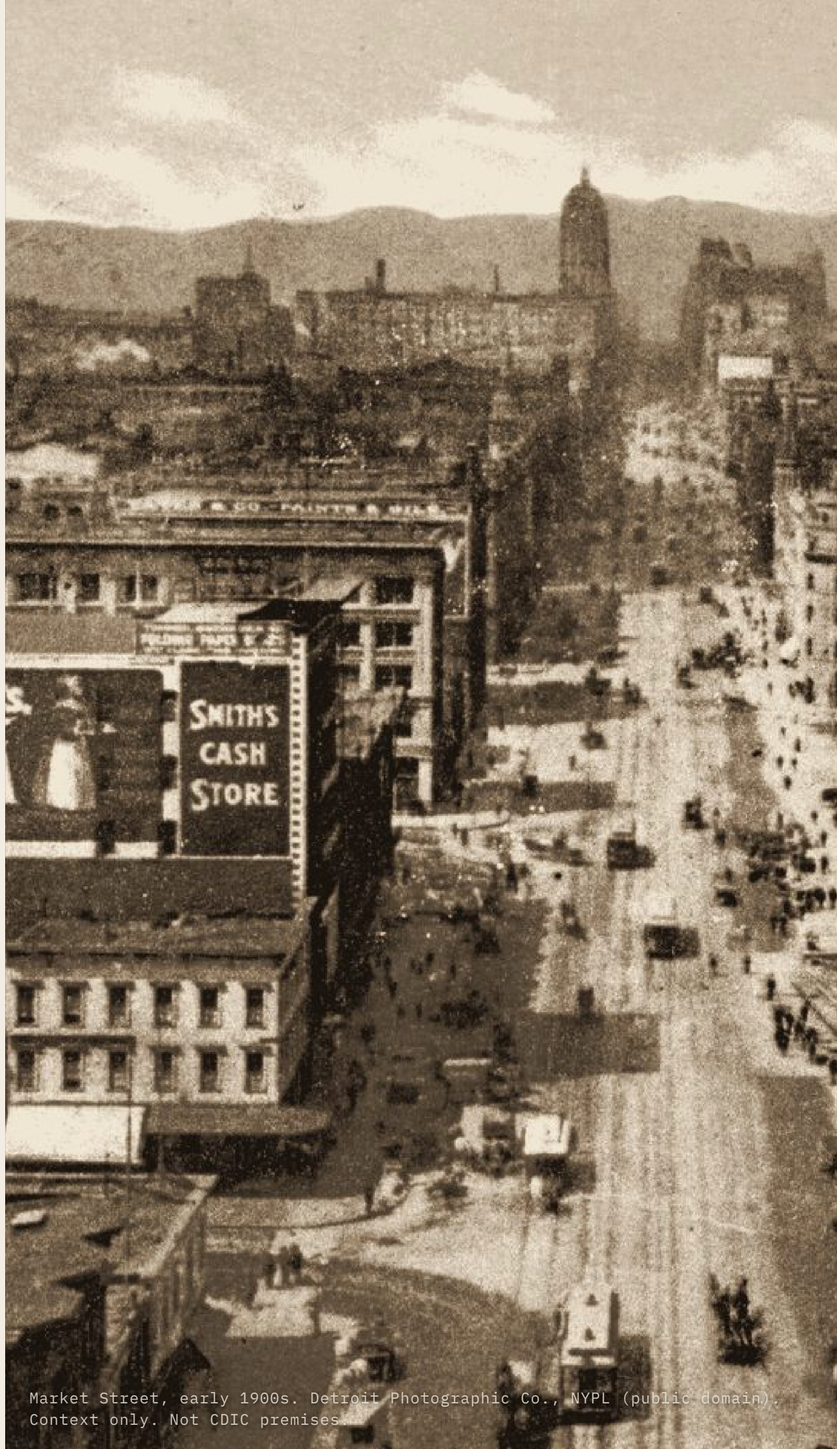
Actual installations, people and process, photographed with each site's permission.

Sales materials

A one-page capabilities sheet, an 8–10 slide deck, readiness checklists and care guides.

Heritage storytelling

Archival finds and family records, published with provenance and permission.



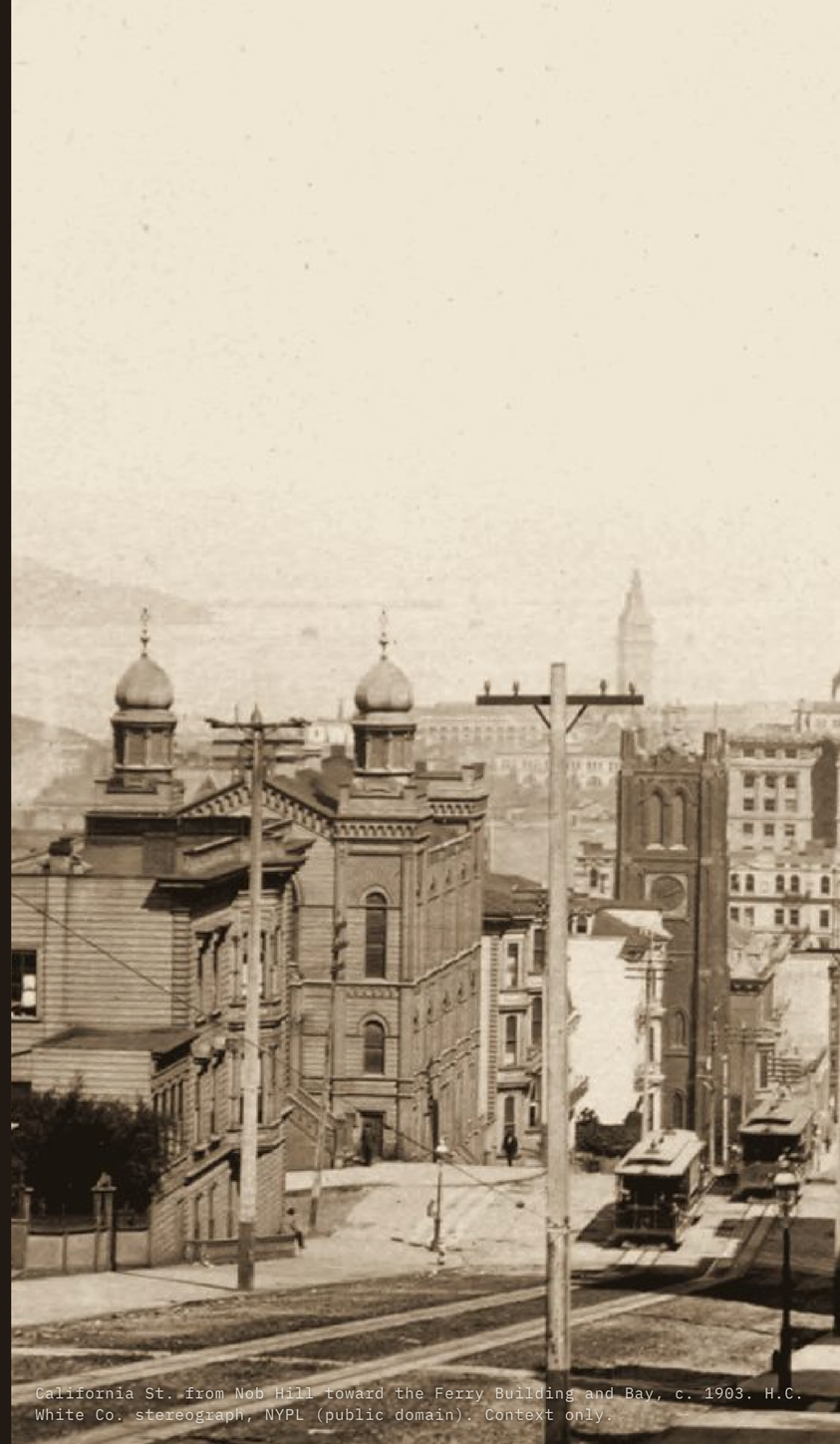
Market Street, early 1900s. Detroit Photographic Co., NYPL (public domain). Context only. Not CDIC premises.

Refine the existing identity first; no full rebrand is assumed

07 · Building the Next Chapter

A practical, collaborative *starting point.*

STEP 1	Review & confirm	Walk through these findings together, confirm company details, and gather brand and history materials.
STEP 2	Organize the service record	One register for accounts and equipment, one channel for service requests, and care routines documented per site.
STEP 3	Refine the offer	Define service packages and standards, and confirm qualified Franke technical coverage.
STEP 4	Present CDIC	Website, capabilities materials, real photography and the heritage story.
STEP 5	Pursue growth	Reconnect relationships, build referral partners and target new offices and renovations.



California St. from Nob Hill toward the Ferry Building and Bay, c. 1903. H.C. White Co. stereograph, NYPL (public domain). Context only.

● RECOMMENDATION Each step begins when the one before is in place

Our first working session

What we'd *review together.*

Whatever exists is enough to start, whether that's a folder, a notebook or conversation.

- [ ] **Company details**
  The approved company name, entity and how CDIC wants to be described.
- [ ] **Technical service**
  Franke relationship, service partners and maintenance records.
- [ ] **Digital assets**
  Domains, email, logos, existing materials and photography.
- [ ] **Customer references**
  Which relationships may be referenced publicly, with permission.
- [ ] **Coffee program**
  Roaster, blends and recipes that define the CDIC experience.
- [ ] **Photo opportunities**
  Sites where installations could be photographed with permission.
- [ ] **Equipment**
  Installed Franke models and configurations, serials and warranty records.
- [ ] **Service standards**
  Visit routines, daily-care arrangements and response expectations.
- [ ] **Family history**
  Photos, letterhead, invoices, signs, and the story of "Oh's" and the move into coffee.

THE KEY QUESTION *Which of these opportunities feel most worth pursuing first?*

CALIFORNIA DIRECT IMPORTING COMPANY

CDIC

Let's build the *next chapter.*

A remarkable history, an established place in a valuable market, and real opportunities ahead. I'd welcome the chance to walk through this research, hear what it's missed, and choose together where to begin.

— Lo



PREPARED BY
DGM | DAILY GRIND MEDIA

Photo: nameless 3791 / Unsplash

Sources & image credits

Research basis. Daily Grind Media research on company records, the corporate coffee market, competitors, Franke A1000 service and business systems (Nov 2026). Findings are research, not audited company records.

Company records. OpenCorporates (LLC 201326310117; corp. C0095574); OpenGovUS SF business listing; SF city directories 1917, 1920 (sfgenealogy.org); Polk directories 1954, 1961–72 (archive.org, ldsgenealogy.com); *Vestkusten* 13 Dec 1923 (CDNC/UCR); Digger Archives leaflet (diggers.org).

Cover. Bird's-eye view of San Francisco up Powell Street, Fairmont Hotel, 1920. Library of Congress Prints & Photographs, LCCN 96514400. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons. Toned and cropped.

Market Street, San Francisco, Cal. Detroit Photographic Co. postcard, early 1900s. NYPL Digital Collections (b12647398-67860). Public domain. Toned and cropped.

Contemporary photography (Unsplash License): Scott K (espresso pour); Kevin Butz (espresso cups); nameless 3791 (latte); Anastasiia Chepinska (coffee beans); Aalo Lens (office lounge). Representative imagery, not CDIC installations.

Market & competitors. National Coffee Association, Fall 2026 release; Savills SF Office Q3 2026; CBRE 2025 Americas Occupier Survey and 2026 workplace research; provider websites as published, Nov 2026.

Equipment. Franke A1000 US specification sheet; Franke A1000 manual (2016 revision); Franke cleaning resources. Installed-unit requirements govern.

Banking Center, San Francisco, Calif. c. 1920. Library of Congress, LCCN 2002711388. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons. Toned and cropped.

Looking down California St. from Nob Hill. H.C. White Co. stereograph, c. 1903. NYPL Digital Collections. Public domain. One frame, toned and cropped.

Image honesty. No AI-generated or retouched-to-invent historical imagery is used. Historical photographs show San Francisco context; none is known to depict CDIC, its premises, people or vehicles.